

School: Hillside Primary School

Date: 24/05/23

Report: Onsite audit walk summary and recommendations

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An onsite visit took place on the 24th May 2023. In addition to reviewing compliance actions, a physical audit walk was completed. A physical audit is useful in supporting the school with physical data risks and remedial actions, including signposting to the latest DPE best practice areas. The walk is also useful in identifying how practice aligns with policy/procedural documentation.

The school has a data protection section on the school website with key data protection documents listed. Staff have completed data protection and cyber security training (Stay Safe Online NCSC). The school has a proactive approach to data protection and compliance.

The following documents/best practice areas on the DPE website can be used to reference against and to obtain additional resources detailed in the report:

- [DPE compliance documents/consent guidance](#)
- [DPE quick reference guide](#)
- [Records management best practice](#)
- [Information and cyber security](#)

Audit walk observations and recommendations are detailed below:

The DPE making the rounds app was used to complete the walk. Details for all areas audited can be accessed from the DPE website: My Activities> Making the Rounds. The report gives details from observations of how sensitive data is stored in classrooms, SENCO office(s) and the staffroom, with server location observation (as documented in the NCC thematic audit 2022). The main admin offices and corridors had positive observations. Consent is obtained for any displays that contain a photo and name. The kitchen had a process for maintaining allergy information securely.

Observations, including how other settings have changed practice and recommendations are detailed below:

Classrooms

Some sensitive data was observed; passwords/usernames, Folders with assessment/intervention and care plans which are kept in each classroom (Rainbow folder). It was ascertained during the walk that there was not a consistent system and folders were in various locations (shelves, cupboards etc) and easily accessible. Debate took place with LB regarding improving the system being used, for example, how would supply staff know where to locate the folder? How do you keep the folders up to date with so many folders (copies of the information are also kept in the admin office, staffroom (care plans) and electronically. How do you ensure adequate security of the folders etc?

Medical boxes with medical information and equipment (epi pens) were easily accessible (i.e. students could access the boxes).

1 x unlocked laptop and 1 x student list with photo.

Some desks/classroom areas would also benefit from a declutter.

Recommendations:

- Rainbow folders: Could you move to an electronic system and have minimised key information available for each class teacher? Could you use a folder system with minimised data that is handed out each day (meaning supply staff will get this information) and returned to the school office at the end of the day. The school could then gradually move over to staff accessing key information electronically with a master folder kept securely in the main admin office? This would reduce the amount of information needed for each classroom and make it easier to maintain the system. If keeping to the current system, build in routines to maintain the folders and raise staff awareness regarding storing securely at the end of the school day. **School to review.**
- For medical boxes, review positioning and safety aspect to avoid students potentially having easy access i.e. Epi pens and medical information.
- Reminder to staff to lock laptops when not in their work area and consider whether staff would benefit from additional cyber security and password training.
- As we are approaching the end of year, reminder to staff regarding lists and displays; remind staff to complete a data cleanse of physical and electronic folders, desks and work areas (clear desk policy).
- Consider additional training for staff i.e. DPE's [NCSC Cyber security training for school staff](#) and [Password nugget training](#)

SENCO office

The key was in the filing cabinet and no staff were present. The staff member was dealing with a student issue so this was acceptable; as you would not be expected to lock your cabinet continually during the day when you are working. End of day routines would include locking the cabinet and/or if you had to leave the office for an extended period lock during the school day.

Unlocked laptop with applications open.

Desk could do with a declutter.

Health care plans on display on the notice board.

The office has secure access. The school should however be aware of who else has access and can view this information (cleaners, caretakers, students, contractors etc).

Recommendations:

- Review the display of the health care plan and if it is still required to be on display. Is there a high risk to the individual? Can the plan be minimised and have a cover? Office has secure/restricted entry.
- Reminder for staff to lock laptops when not in their work area and consider whether the staff member would benefit from additional cyber security and password training.
- The area had a lot of data and this may have been because the staff member was working. It is worth noting and checking what information is left out and what's added to secure storage at the end of the school day. As the office will have a lot of sensitive data, it is good practice to operate a clear desk policy as much as possible, which will avoid sensitive data being viewed by staff not authorised i.e. students, cleaners and caretakers.

Staffroom

Photo and first name/initial of students with care plans.

Note: Although the information has been minimised schools are adopting different methods to communicate this information rather than having it on display in the staffroom. Folders are also kept electronically, in the front office and each classroom has a folder. This means that there are multiple systems to maintain which can prove problematic.

Recommendations: Similar to the classroom Rainbow folders, school to review the process and methods for communicating this information.

IT server area

Server is in an open area/library.

Recommendations: Discuss with IT provider in relation to NCC thematic audit 2022. Document risks and mitigations.